

Lesson 1: Women at Work: The Current Situation

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When Pat started her career in the 1970s, less than *half* of women over the age of 16 were working outside the home. In today's workforce, nearly 50 years later, however, women have emerged as a large part of the U.S. economy.

When it comes to women in the workforce, some may wonder, "What's the big deal? We're equal, aren't we?"

Yes and no.

Women may be equal on paper in certain areas and by certain laws, but a multitude of obstacles still face women trying to succeed in the workforce and advance their career.

This includes factors like:

Unequal pay: In her first season, Pat earned a little under \$9,000 for her first position as head basketball coach at the University of Tennessee, during a time when many male counterparts were making twice as much.

Unequal representation in certain industries: In Pat's own field of coaching, today only one-third of all head coaches are women, while two-thirds are men.

Caregiving responsibilities: It's no secret that working mothers (like Pat) often face additional hurdles. The lack of affordable childcare in addition to domestic duties often forces women to choose between career advancement and family.

Underrepresentation in leadership and gender stereotypes and biases are just a few more ways women lag behind men in advancement opportunities and perceptions in the workforce.

So, what can we do about it? The first step is understanding the current situation and how to navigate the current climate.

What makes things challenge for many female leaders is that many of the complexities of the status quo facing women often feel difficult and hard to prove. After all, it isn't a standard topic of conversation. Women have learned to persevere in spite of it all. At best...no one talks about it.

That's what makes the upcoming lessons so valuable! You'll learn about some of the pitfalls of the current workforce for women and how we got here, shining a light on some of the solutions for women and would-be leaders in their careers.

As a female leader and working mother, I've found it's best to be up front and transparent about our needs so we can perform our roles to the best of our abilities. When one area falls out of balance, other parts of our life do as well, and it impacts our work. What I've found helpful during my career is having strong female mentors to help advise on difficult situations while supporting and encouraging my growth as a leader.

In this course you'll learn to face challenges with strength and resilience like Pat did and specifically how to view some of the unique obstacles facing women in their fields.